Finance JD Gap-Filler: What Companies Actually Ask

What Real 2026 JDs Demand That Your Other Guides Don't Teach

Tools, standards, frameworks & skills to close the gap — ERP, Blackline, Bloomberg, regulatory, AML tooling, ESG, AI, GCC ops

Contents

The Gap Map: What Real JDs Demand vs What You Already Have

The method: read the JD, subtract your bundles, keep the remainder

You already own six finance study bundles. Between them they teach Excel and financial modelling (Power Query, DCF, LBO, sensitivity tables), Data/BI (SQL, Python pandas, Power BI + DAX, Tableau), Accounting and ERP at the level of hands-on TallyPrime plus an *overview* of SAP FICO, reconciliations, month-end, Ind AS, Schedule III and MIS, Taxation (GST, TDS, income tax, ITR, tax audit), FP&A (budgets, forecasts, variance, driver models), and the knowledge layer of markets, valuation, credit and risk. That is a genuinely strong base. It is also, in 2026, table stakes — the stuff every shortlisted candidate has.

This guide is built by a subtraction. I took the actual mid-2026 India job descriptions in the evidence pack — HP's R2R role, Dentsu's Financial Control seat, Luxoft's finance-and-financial-crime tech reqs, Street Neon's research desk, plus Franklin Templeton, Accenture, Genpact, Acuity, Citi and Intel — and I listed *everything* they demand. Then I crossed off everything your six bundles already teach. What survives that crossing-off is the gap. That remainder is this guide.

The point is blunt: your bundles get you *qualified*. The remainder is what gets you *shortlisted* — the specific enterprise tool, standard, or framework named in the JD that a generalist candidate cannot speak to.

The master demand list

Every capability named across the evidence JDs, grouped, with an honest verdict on where your existing bundles leave you:

#	Demand cluster	What JDs literally ask for	Your coverage
1	**Enterprise ERP depth**	"Hands on experience in SAP" (HP); SAP, Oracle, Hyperion (Accenture); Workday Financials, SAP Finance (Luxoft)	**GAP** — you have Tally + an SAP *overview*, not FICO T-code fluency, S/4HANA, Oracle Fusion, Workday, NetSuite, D365
2	**Consolidation & close tech**	"SAP BPC and Blackline an added advantage" (Dentsu); Hyperion, Anaplan (Accenture)	**GAP** — recon *concept* known; the tools that run group close are not
3	**Automation beyond pandas**	"Automate data workflows" (HP); "VBA, Power Automate, Alteryx" (Franklin Templeton)	**partly** — Power Query/Python known; VBA, Power Automate, Alteryx, agentic workflows are gaps
4	**Market-data terminals**	"Bloomberg, Capital IQ, Refinitiv, FactSet" (Street Neon); Bloomberg/Refinitiv/MSCI/Markit (Acuity)	**GAP** — terminal function fluency (DES, GP, FA, EQS) not taught
5	**Accounting standards & controls**	"US GAAP & IFRS"; "SOX / J-SOX controls" (HP, Dentsu)	**partly** — you have Ind AS + Schedule III; US GAAP contrasts, IFRS depth, SOX/ICFR testing are gaps
6	**Regulatory reporting**	"Regulatory Reporting, Basel, IFRS, Liquidity/Capital" + AxiomSL, OneSumX, Regnology (Luxoft)	**GAP** — Basel/RBI returns and reg-reporting engines not covered
7	**AML / financial-crime tooling**	"AML, KYC, CDD, Sanctions, Fraud" + Actimize, SAS AML, Quantexa, World-Check (Luxoft, Citi)	**GAP** — fin-crime domain and tools absent
8	**ESG & sustainability finance**	BRSR, CSRD, assurance (implicit in 2026 controller/audit roles)	**GAP** — not in any bundle
9	**AI / GenAI in finance**	"AI Gigafactory / agentic AI" (Genpact); GenAI push across 2026 GCC JDs	**GAP** — using LLMs/copilots in a controlled finance workflow not taught
10	**GCC operating model**	R2R/P2P/O2C towers, SLAs, shared-services (HP, Genpact, Accenture)	**GAP** — the operating model these roles sit inside is unstated in bundles
11	**Treasury tech**	"Treasury, TMS, settlements, money markets, hedging FX" (Dentsu, Intel)	**GAP** — treasury workflows and TMS not covered
12	**Analyst soft skills**	"BS commentary for BS calls", "audit support", stakeholder comms	**partly** — modelling known; commentary, review notes, audit interaction are gaps

Seven hard GAPs, four partials, and a base you can already stand on. That is the shape of the work.

How to use this guide

Each following chapter takes **one** cluster and treats it as a stand-alone gap with the same six sections, so you can read them in any order and stop when a chapter is already covered:

1. **The gap** — what it is and, in one line, why your bundles don't reach it.
2. **Why companies ask for it** — grounded in a real quoted posting, and which roles need it.
3. **What "proficient" looks like** — the concrete bar an employer tests, so you know when you're done.
4. **How to actually learn/do it** — real screens, menus, T-codes, terminal functions and step-by-step workflows, with free ways to practise. Where a tool needs paid access, I say so and give the free alternative.
5. **How it shows up in interviews** — two or three exact questions with strong answers.
6. **ATS keywords to add** — the precise terms to seed into your resume so the parser and the recruiter both find them.

A suggested path: if you are aiming at **GCC R2R / controllership** (HP, Dentsu, Genpact), prioritise chapters on Enterprise ERP, Consolidation & Close tech, US GAAP/IFRS + SOX, GCC operating model, and automation. If you are aiming at **buy/sell-side research or model risk** (Street Neon, Acuity), prioritise Market-data terminals, then the AI and automation chapters. If you are aiming at **banking finance/fin-crime tech** (Luxoft, Citi, Intel), prioritise Regulatory reporting, AML/fin-crime tooling, and Treasury tech.

Why these are the differentiators

Recruiters and ATS systems in 2026 do not filter on "knows accounting". They filter on named nouns: *SAP S/4HANA, Blackline, SOX, AxiomSL, Bloomberg, Actimize, BRSR, Anaplan*. Those nouns are exactly the remainder above — the things that survive after you subtract the general knowledge everyone has. A candidate who can say "I've reconciled in Blackline's matching module and understand how an auto-cert rule works" beats ten candidates who wrote "strong reconciliation skills". That is the entire thesis of this guide: your bundles make you employable; these gaps make you *the* shortlist. The rest of the book plugs them one by one.

> **How to read the verdicts:** "covered" = a bundle already teaches it, skip that chapter. "partly" = you have the concept but not the named tool/standard — read for the specifics. "GAP" = start here; this is net-new and it is what the JD is actually screening for.

Enterprise ERP Depth: SAP (beyond overview), Oracle, Workday, NetSuite, D365

The gap

Your bundles give you hands-on TallyPrime and an *overview* of SAP FICO — enough to define what a GL is, not enough to survive a screening call that asks "which T-code do you post a vendor invoice in?". Every mid-2026 MNC/GCC finance JD assumes daily life *inside* an enterprise ERP, and Tally is not one. The gap is transactional fluency in SAP FICO plus literacy in the other four systems you will be asked about — Oracle, Workday, NetSuite, Dynamics 365 — because your existing material stops at the overview.

Why companies ask for it

> Real posting (HP, R2R Bangalore): "Hands on experience in SAP... R2R, AR & P2P; Automate data workflows." Real posting (Accenture FP&A): "SAP, Oracle, Hyperion, Anaplan." Real posting (Luxoft): "SAP Finance, Workday Financials, Oracle Financial Services."

Who needs it: any Record-to-Report, AP/AR, General Accounting, financial-control or FP&A seat in a GCC or MNC (HP, Dentsu, Genpact, Accenture, Intel). The ERP *is* the job — you post, extract, reconcile and report inside it eight hours a day. SME and startup roles lean NetSuite or D365; large listed and captive-shared-services lean SAP; Oracle Fusion and Workday show up in specific captives.

What "proficient" looks like

The bar for an entry-to-mid R2R/GL accountant is not configuration — that's a consultant's job. It is confident *end-user* operation: you know the module map (FI vs CO), you can name and use the day-to-day T-codes without a cheat sheet, you understand the document flow (a posting creates a document number, hits the GL, updates sub-ledgers), and you can pull and interrogate a line-item report. You can also say, accurately, which SAP version you worked on and the difference from the current one. For the other ERPs the bar is lower: know what each is, who uses it, and the equivalent concept, so you're not blank when a recruiter mentions it.

How to actually learn/do it

SAP FICO — the module map. FI (Financial Accounting: GL, AP, AR, Asset Accounting, Bank) produces the external statements; CO (Controlling: cost centres, internal orders, profit centres, product costing) is the internal/management view. R2R lives mostly in FI-GL; P2P touches FI-AP; O2C touches FI-AR.

The T-codes to actually memorise (a T-code is typed into the command box top-left):

T-code	Does	Area
`FB50`	Post a GL document (enter view)	FI-GL
`F-02`	Post a GL document (general, with posting keys)	FI-GL
`FB60`	Post a vendor (AP) invoice	FI-AP
`FB70`	Post a customer (AR) invoice	FI-AR
`F-53` / `F110`	Manual payment / automatic payment run	FI-AP
`FBL1N` / `FBL5N` / `FBL3N`	Vendor / customer / GL line-item display	Reporting
`FS10N`	GL account balance display	Reporting
`FAGLB03`	GL balance (new GL)	Reporting
`AS01` / `AFAB`	Create asset / run depreciation	FI-AA
`F.05` / `FAGL_FC_VAL`	Foreign-currency revaluation	Month-end

Tiny worked example — post and verify a rent accrual. In `FB50`, enter company code, document date, then two lines: debit *Rent Expense* ₹1,00,000 (posting key 40), credit *Accrued Liabilities* ₹1,00,000 (posting key 50); the debits-equal-credits indicator must go green; simulate, then post — SAP returns "Document 1000000123 posted". Verify it in `FBL3N` by opening the Accrued Liabilities GL and filtering on your document number. That five-minute loop — post, get a doc number, trace it in a line-item report — is exactly what "hands on SAP" means on a JD.

S/4HANA vs ECC. ECC (ECC 6.0) is the legacy on-premise version many captives still run; S/4HANA is the current (2026) in-memory successor. Say the difference credibly: S/4HANA merges FI and CO into the **Universal Journal (table ACDOCA)** so there's a single source of truth and no reconciliation between FI and CO; the **Business Partner** replaces separate customer/vendor masters; the UI is **Fiori** tiles rather than the old SAP GUI; and reporting is real-time on line items. If you trained on ECC, say ECC — don't claim S/4 you haven't seen.

The other four, in one line each. *Oracle Fusion Cloud ERP* (and legacy *E-Business Suite/EBS*) — large enterprises; the finance module is "Oracle Financials", navigation is web-based, the equivalent of a GL inquiry is the Account Inspector/Financial Reporting. *Workday Financials* — HR-first companies extending into finance; everything is a "business process" with worklets, no T-codes. *NetSuite* (Oracle) — the default cloud ERP for mid-market/SME and startups; role-based dashboards, saved searches instead of T-codes. *Microsoft Dynamics 365 Finance* — Microsoft-shop mid-market; tightly integrated with Excel and Power Platform.

How to get hands-on for free / cheap. - **SAP** — no fully-free live system, but: (1) SAP Learning (learning.sap.com) has free courses and **openSAP**; (2) a personal **S/4HANA Fully-Activated Appliance** trial runs on SAP Cloud Appliance Library (you pay only cloud compute, a few dollars/day, stoppable); (3) YouTube walkthroughs of `FB50` / `FBL3N` let you rehearse the exact screens; (4) SAP Learning Hub (paid) if an employer sponsors it. - **Oracle** — Oracle offers free Cloud ERP trial/guided tours via Oracle University; **Oracle Cloud Free Tier** for the tech side. - **NetSuite** — request a product tour/demo; SuiteLife learning content is free to browse. - **Dynamics 365** — a **free 30-day trial** of D365 Finance is genuinely self-serve at trials.dynamics.com; spin one up and post a journal. - **Workday** — no public trial; learn the vocabulary from Workday's docs and demo videos.

How it shows up in interviews

Q: "Walk me through how you'd post a vendor invoice in SAP and then check it hit the ledger." A: "I'd use `FB60` — enter the vendor, invoice date, amount, tax code and the expense GL and cost object. On posting SAP generates a document number. To verify, I'd open `FBL1N` for that vendor to see the open item, and `FBL3N` or `FS10N` on the expense GL to confirm the debit. At month-end that open item would clear against the payment run via `F110`."

Q: "Have you worked on S/4HANA or ECC — what's the difference?" A: "I trained on [be honest]. The key change in S/4HANA is the Universal Journal, table ACDOCA — FI and CO postings share one line-item table, so there's no FI-CO reconciliation and reporting is real-time. Master data moves to the Business Partner model and the front end is Fiori instead of the classic GUI."

Q: "We run NetSuite, you've used SAP — is that a problem?" A: "The concepts transfer directly — chart of accounts, subsidiaries, sub-ledgers, period close. NetSuite replaces T-codes with role dashboards and saved searches; I'd be productive on the transaction set within days and I've already run a trial to see the posting flow."

ATS keywords to add

SAP FICO, SAP S/4HANA, SAP ECC, FI-GL, FI-AP, FI-AR, Asset Accounting, Universal Journal (ACDOCA), FB50, FB60, FBL3N, FS10N, F110, Record-to-Report (R2R), P2P, O2C, Oracle Fusion Cloud ERP, Oracle EBS, Workday Financials, NetSuite, Microsoft Dynamics 365 Finance, ERP end-user, GL posting, period-end close.

Consolidation & Close Tech: SAP BPC, Blackline, HFM/FCCS, OneStream

The gap

Your bundles teach the *concept* of reconciliation and month-end close — matching balances, posting accruals, variance MIS. What they don't teach is the *software* that MNCs and GCCs actually run those closes on: the reconciliation-automation platform (Blackline) and the consolidation engines (SAP BPC, Oracle HFM/FCCS, OneStream). This is a pure tool gap — you know *what* a group consolidation and an account recon are; you don't know the screens where they happen, and the JDs name the screens.

Why companies ask for it

> Real posting (Dentsu, Financial Control Bangalore): "SAP BPC (Business Planning & Consolidation) and Blackline tool an added advantage... budget & reforecast BPC submissions... Balance sheet reconciliations & commentary for BS calls." Real posting (HP): "Ensure compliance with internal & SOX controls" (Blackline is HP's recon control tool). Real posting (Accenture): "Hyperion, Anaplan."

Who needs it: group/financial-control accountants, R2R leads and FP&A analysts in any multi-entity MNC or captive GCC. The moment a company has more than a handful of legal entities in multiple currencies, close and recon move off spreadsheets onto these platforms for auditability and SOX evidence. Naming them credibly is a direct differentiator for controllership seats.

What "proficient" looks like

You are not configuring the tool (that's an admin/consultant). The bar is: you can describe and operate the *workflow*. For **Blackline** — you know the reconciliation lifecycle (prepare → auto-match → certify → approve), what a matching rule and an auto-certification threshold do, and how it produces SOX evidence. For **consolidation tools** — you understand what consolidation software does that a spreadsheet can't: intercompany elimination, currency translation, minority interest, and controlled *submissions* from each entity. You can say which tool you touched and describe one real task (a BPC budget submission, a Blackline balance-sheet recon) without inventing depth you don't have.

How to actually learn/do it

Blackline — the account-reconciliation workflow

Blackline replaces the "reconciliation Excel" with a controlled, audited system. The lifecycle for one GL account each month:

1. **Import** — the GL balance (from SAP/Oracle) and supporting sub-ledger/bank data auto-load into Blackline.
2. **Prepare** — the preparer opens the account's recon template, explains the balance (e.g. lists the open items making up an Accrued Liabilities balance), and attaches support.

3. **Auto-match** — Blackline's **Transaction Matching** module matches thousands of lines (e.g. bank vs GL) by rules you set, leaving only exceptions for humans. This is the big time-saver over Excel.
4. **Auto-certify** — accounts meeting a rule (e.g. balance is zero, or unchanged, or below a risk threshold) can be **auto-certified**, so preparers focus only on risky accounts.
5. **Certify → Review → Approve** — preparer certifies, reviewer approves; every action is timestamped with the user — that trail *is* the SOX control evidence.

Alongside recon, Blackline runs **Task Management** (the close checklist, who does what by when — a digital close calendar) and a **Journal Entry** module (create, route for approval, post back to the ERP). On a JD, "Blackline" almost always means the account-reconciliation + task-management combo used as a SOX close control.

Consolidation engines — what they do that Excel can't

All four (SAP BPC, Oracle HFM, Oracle FCCS, OneStream) do the same core job: take each legal entity's trial balance and produce **group** financials. The steps they automate:

- **Submissions** — each entity submits its trial balance into the tool (Dentsu's "BPC submissions").
- **Currency translation** — restate each entity from local currency to group reporting currency at the right rates (average for P&L, closing for balance sheet), booking the **CTA** (currency translation adjustment).
- **Intercompany elimination** — cancel intragroup sales/purchases and receivables/payables so the group isn't double-counted; the tool flags IC mismatches.
- **Adjustments & minority interest** — consolidation journals, goodwill, non-controlling interest.
- **Output** — group P&L, balance sheet, and the numbers behind the "BS calls".

Who uses which: **SAP BPC** in SAP shops (now succeeded by *SAP Group Reporting* / SAC in S/4 estates, but BPC is still everywhere in 2026); **Oracle Hyperion HFM** legacy on-prem and its cloud successor **Oracle FCCS**; **OneStream** the fast-growing unified CPM challenger; **Anaplan** more for planning than statutory consolidation; **Trintech Cadency** a Blackline competitor for recon + close.

A BPC submission, concretely. BPC runs as an Excel add-in (**EPM add-in**) or web. You open an input schedule bound to the model, select your entity/version (e.g. Actual vs Budget vs Forecast) and time period from the member dimensions, type or load your numbers into the grid, run any **Business Rules** (e.g. IC eliminations), then **Submit/Save** to write to the model. That "select dimensions → enter → submit" loop is what "BPC budget & reforecast submissions" on the Dentsu JD means.

Free / cheap ways to learn the concepts

- **Blackline** — no free live tenant, but Blackline **University** and the Blackline **U** YouTube/demo library walk through the exact recon and matching screens; watch a "how to certify a reconciliation" demo and you can speak to it. The vendor also runs frequent webinars.
- **Consolidation logic** — you can learn 90% of it *for free in Excel*: build a two-subsidiary consolidation — translate a foreign sub's TB at closing/average rates, book the CTA, eliminate an intercompany sale and the matching receivable/payable, and produce a consolidated TB. Doing this once teaches you what the tools automate, which is exactly what interviewers probe.
- **OneStream / Oracle / SAP** — OneStream, Oracle (FCCS) and SAP publish free product tours, documentation and community learning; openSAP occasionally runs BPC/Group Reporting courses.

- **Standards backing** — the consolidation logic maps to **Ind AS 110 / IFRS 10** (consolidation), **Ind AS 21 / IAS 21** (currency translation) and **Ind AS 28** (associates); you already have the standards, now attach the tool vocabulary to them.

How it shows up in interviews

Q: "Explain the Blackline reconciliation workflow and how it supports SOX." A: "Balances auto-import from the ERP into an account template. The preparer explains the balance and attaches support; Transaction Matching auto-clears the routine lines by rule, and low-risk accounts auto-certify against a threshold, so effort concentrates on risky accounts. The preparer certifies, a reviewer approves, and every step is user-and-time stamped. That timestamped preparer/reviewer trail is the SOX control evidence that the recon was performed and independently reviewed."

Q: "What does a consolidation tool like SAP BPC or HFM do that a spreadsheet can't?" A: "It enforces controlled submissions from each entity, then automates currency translation with the CTA, intercompany eliminations with mismatch flagging, and consolidation adjustments and minority interest — all with an audit trail and locked versions (Actual vs Budget vs Forecast). Spreadsheets can compute the same numbers but can't give you the control, the multi-entity IC matching at scale, or the auditability the external auditors and BS calls need."

Q: "You've listed BPC — what did you actually do in it?" A: "I worked on the submission side: opening the input schedule in the EPM Excel add-in, selecting entity, version and period from the dimensions, entering budget/reforecast numbers, running the business rules and submitting to the model, then pulling a report to check it consolidated." (Say only what's true; if it's Excel-simulated, say "I've replicated the consolidation logic in Excel and studied the BPC submission flow.")

ATS keywords to add

Blackline, account reconciliation automation, Transaction Matching, auto-certification, close task management, SAP BPC, EPM add-in, budget & forecast submissions, Oracle Hyperion HFM, Oracle FCCS, OneStream, Anaplan, Trintech Cadency, group consolidation, intercompany elimination, currency translation (CTA), minority/non-controlling interest, SOX control evidence, balance-sheet reconciliation & commentary, IFRS 10 / Ind AS 110.

Automation Beyond Power Query: Alteryx, Power Automate, VBA

The gap

You can already shape data in Power Query, model in Python, and build Power BI dashboards. But a large slice of 2026 finance JDs — especially at asset managers, GCCs and Big-4 managed services — still runs on three tools your bundles never touched: **Alteryx** (drag-and-drop ETL for analysts who don't code), **Microsoft Power Automate** (workflow/approval/email robots), and **VBA** (the Excel macro language that refuses to die). They are named explicitly, together, on real postings — and none of your six bundles teach them.

Why companies ask for it

> **Real posting (Franklin Templeton, Fund Accounting / FA):** "VBA, Power Automate, Power BI, Alteryx."

That one line names all three. Franklin Templeton, Accenture, Genpact and most fund-admin / FP&A shared-service teams list them because their existing process estate is Excel-and-email; they want people who can *retrofit* automation onto legacy workflows without a full data-engineering project. Roles: **Fund Accounting, FP&A analysts, R2R/RTR teams, MIS analysts, financial-reporting associates, RPA/finance-transformation** roles in GCCs.

Why not just Python? Governance. In a bank or fund admin, IT won't let you run arbitrary Python against the GL. Alteryx and Power Automate are *sanctioned, auditable, licensed* platforms with lineage and logging — that's the whole reason they get paid for.

What "proficient" looks like

The employer tests whether you can:

- Build an **Alteryx workflow** end-to-end: pull two files, clean, join, aggregate, and output — and explain each tool container.
- Stand up a **Power Automate flow** that triggers on an email/file/schedule, applies a condition, and sends an approval or a report.
- **Record, then edit** a VBA macro — add a loop, a variable, an `If`, and error handling — not just hit record.
- Say **when to use which** (the decision matters more than syntax).

How to actually learn/do it

Alteryx Designer

The whole product is a left-hand **tool palette** you drag onto a canvas and wire together left-to-right. Learn these categories:

Palette	Key tools	What it does
In/Out	Input Data, Output Data, Browse	Read CSV/Excel/DB, write result, preview mid-stream
Preparation	Select, Filter, Formula, Sort, Sample, Data Cleansing	Pick/rename columns, `WHERE` , new calculated fields
Join	Join, Union, Join Multiple, Find Replace	`VLOOKUP` /merge on keys, stack tables
Transform	Summarize, Cross Tab, Transpose	Group-by/pivot/unpivot
Parse	Text to Columns, RegEx, DateTime	Split and reformat

Worked example — a 2-minute recon: Input `GL.xlsx` → Input `Bank.csv` → **Select** to standardise the amount/date types on each → **Join** on `TxnID` → the **L and R (unmatched) outputs** are your exceptions, the **J (inner)** output is matched → **Summarize** the exceptions by amount → **Output Data** to `breaks.xlsx` . The unmatched anchors of a Join tool ARE the reconciliation. Wrap it once and it re-runs monthly in one click.

Free practice: Alteryx offers a free **14-day Designer trial** and a permanent **free "Designer Cloud" / Community edition** plus the **Weekly Challenge** archive and free "Foundational Micro-Credential" on the Alteryx Community — genuinely the fastest way to a line on the resume.

Microsoft Power Automate

A **flow** = **Trigger** → **Action(s)**, built in a browser at make.powerautomate.com. It's almost certainly already in your Microsoft 365 licence.

- **Trigger** types: *automated* (When a new email arrives / a file is created in SharePoint), *scheduled* (Recurrence, e.g. every weekday 7 am), *instant* (button/manual).
- **Core actions**: Condition (If/Yes-No branch), Apply to each (loop), Get items (SharePoint/Excel table), Send an email (V2), Start and wait for an approval, Create file, HTTP.

Worked example — invoice approval: Trigger *When a new email arrives* with attachment → **Condition** subject contains "Invoice" → **Start and wait for an approval** (Approve/Reject) sent to the manager → on Approve, **Create file** in the "Approved" SharePoint folder and **Send an email** to AP. Zero code. This is the classic FP&A/AP demo.

Free practice: Any personal Microsoft account gets Power Automate free-tier; Microsoft Learn has free guided modules and there's a free desktop RPA client (**Power Automate for desktop**) bundled with Windows 11 for clicking legacy apps.

VBA

Open the editor with **Alt + F11**. To learn fast: **Developer tab** → **Record Macro**, do the task once, stop, then **read and edit** the generated code — that's how everyone actually learns VBA.

A real finance macro — loop through sheets and PDF each cost-centre's MIS:

```
Sub ExportCostCentres()
    Dim ws As Worksheet
    Dim path As String
    path = ThisWorkbook.Path & "\MIS\"
    For Each ws In ThisWorkbook.Worksheets          ' loop
        If Left(ws.Name, 2) = "CC" Then             ' If condition
            ws.ExportAsFixedFormat Type:=xlTypePDF, _
                Filename:=path & ws.Name & ".pdf"
        End If
    Next ws
    MsgBox "Done"
End Sub
```

That single macro shows the four things interviewers probe: a **variable** (`Dim`), a **loop** (`For Each`), an `If` , and a real action. Add `On Error Resume Next` for basic error handling. **Free practice:** any Excel install — no licence, no internet.

When to use which

Need	Reach for
Repeatable multi-file **ETL / recon / blending**, no code, auditable	**Alteryx**
Cross-app workflow — email, approvals, SharePoint, Teams, scheduled reports	**Power Automate**
Manipulate **inside one workbook**, format, loop cells, quick-and-dirty	**VBA**
Heavy transforms already loading a model	**Power Query** (you have this)
Data science / large data / ML	**Python** (you have this)

Rule of thumb: *data in files → Alteryx; actions across apps → Power Automate; things inside Excel → VBA.*

How it shows up in interviews

Q: "You get two files — our GL export and the bank statement — every morning. Walk me through automating the reconciliation without writing Python." A: "In Alteryx: two Input tools, a Select on each to normalise date and amount types, then a Join on the transaction key. The inner output is matched; the two unmatched anchors are my breaks, which I Summarize by amount and Output to an exceptions file. I'd schedule it, or hand it off in Power Automate on a 7 am recurrence that emails the exceptions to the team."

Q: "Difference between Power Automate and VBA — when would you pick each?" A: "VBA lives inside one Excel workbook and is great for formatting, looping cells, or generating PDFs locally, but it can't reach email approvals or SharePoint cleanly and needs the file open. Power Automate is cloud, event-driven and cross-app — approvals, notifications, scheduled report distribution — with logging and governance IT accepts. I'd use VBA for in-workbook work and Power Automate for anything that crosses apps."

Q: "How do you learn a macro if you don't know the syntax?" A: "Record it first, then open Alt+F11 and refactor the recorded code — replace absolute references with variables, wrap repeated steps in a For loop, add an If and `On Error` handling. Recording teaches you the object model faster than any tutorial."

ATS keywords to add

Alteryx, Alteryx Designer, workflow automation, data blending, ETL, Power Automate, Microsoft Power Automate, Power Automate for desktop, RPA, robotic process automation, approval workflows, VBA, Excel macros, macro automation, process automation, finance transformation, automated reconciliation, scheduled reporting, Power Automate flows, Alteryx Core Micro-Credential

Market-Data Terminals Hands-On: Bloomberg, Refinitiv, FactSet, Capital IQ

The gap

Your knowledge guides *mention* Bloomberg and Capital IQ; they never teach you to **drive** them. Every equity research, IB, PE, credit and buy-side JD assumes you can sit at a terminal and pull a company, a comp set, a chart and a screen in seconds. That muscle memory — the function codes, the Excel add-ins — is the gap, and it's the one that separates "I've heard of Bloomberg" from "I've used Bloomberg."

Why companies ask for it

> **Real posting (Street Neon, Institutional Research, Mumbai):** "Familiarity with financial databases such as Bloomberg, Capital IQ, Refinitiv, FactSet."
>
> **Real posting (Acuity, Model Risk):** data sources "Bloomberg / Refinitiv / MSCI / Markit / CapIQ."

Roles: **equity/credit research associate, IB analyst, PE/VC associate, buy-side analyst, model-risk and market-risk analysts, KPO/research at Acuity, Moody's, MSCI, Evalueserve.** These are the terminals the whole capital-markets industry runs on; the JD uses "familiarity with" as a polite filter for people who've never touched one.

What "proficient" looks like

You can, without a manual: pull a security's description and financials, build a trading comps set, chart relative performance, run an equity screen, and — crucially — **pull the data into Excel** with the add-in so a model refreshes live. On Bloomberg specifically, you know the **function-then-`<GO>`** grammar and a dozen core mnemonics.

How to actually learn/do it

Bloomberg Terminal

Grammar: type a **ticker + yellow market key** (e.g. `AAPL US <Equity>`), then a **function mnemonic**, then hit `<GO>` (the green key). `HELP HELP` opens live chat with Bloomberg staff — free, 24/7, the best learning shortcut there is.

Function	Does
DES	Company/security description — the front page
FA	Financial Analysis — full financials, ratios, segments
GP	Line chart (GIP intraday, G historical)
RV	Relative Value — comparable companies table
EQS	Equity Screening — build a rules-based screen
SRCH	Fixed-income / bond search
PORT	Portfolio & risk analytics
BQL / FLDS	Bloomberg Query Language; field finder
N / CN	News; company news
WEI / ECO	World equity indices; economic calendar

Excel add-in (the part that matters for a modelling job): - `=BDP("AAPL US Equity","PX_LAST")` — one current value (Bloomberg Data Point). - `=BDH("AAPL US Equity","PX_LAST","1/1/2025","6/30/2026")` — a history series (Data History). - `=BDS(…)` — bulk/set data (e.g. all holders). - **BQL** for complex screens/aggregations in one formula. Master `BDP` / `BDH` and you can wire a live comps sheet in minutes.

Free/cheap access: the **Bloomberg Market Concepts (BMC)** e-learning course (~8 hours, ~₹1,600 / paid but often free through a university) gives a **certificate** you list on the resume and teaches the exact functions above. Many Indian B-school libraries and some public libraries have a terminal — book an hour.

Refinitiv (LSEG) Eikon / Workspace

Eikon is being replaced by **Workspace**. It's more **search-bar and app-driven** than Bloomberg's command line — type a company name, open the Company Overview app. Excel add-in functions: `=TR(…)` and the newer `=RDP.Data(…)`, plus a point-and-click **"Build Formula"** wizard so you don't memorise field names. Best for: **FX, fixed income, commodities, and news** (Reuters), and often cheaper than Bloomberg, so common in Indian KPOs.

FactSet

Menu/workstation-driven rather than command-line; strong at **portfolio analytics, quant screening (Universal Screening), and clean, presentation-ready comps/tearsheets**. Excel add-in: `=FDS(…)` codes and the FactSet ribbon. Loved by buy-side and IB for its Excel/PowerPoint model-building tools.

S&P Capital IQ (CapIQ / CIQ)

Web platform + the killer **Excel plug-in** (`=CIQ(…)`). Best for **screening, trading & transaction comps, and credit**: - **Screening**: build a universe (sector, geography, size, metrics) → export. - **Comps**: pull a company → "Comparable Companies" / "Precedent Transactions" (M&A deals) → export the whole table to Excel. - The CIQ Excel formulas let you build a bankers' comps sheet that refreshes. CapIQ is the standard for **PE/M&A/credit** shops in India.

Preqin

The **private-markets** database — **PE, VC, private credit, real assets, infrastructure**: fund performance (IRR/TVPI), fund managers (GPs), LPs, and deal/fundraising data you cannot get from public terminals. Named on PE/fund-of-funds and placement-agent JDs.

Free / cheap alternatives to practise on (India-first)

Paid tool	Free stand-in
Bloomberg/CapIQ **screener**	**Screener.in**, **Tijori Finance**, **TradingView** screener
Company financials / filings	**Screener.in**, **NSE**/**BSE** corporate filings, **MCA**, company IR pages
Charts (GP)	**TradingView**, NSE charts
Macro (ECO)	**RBI**, **MOSPI**, **FRED**, **Trading Economics**
Bond search (SRCH)	**NSE/BSE debt**, RBI, **CCIL**
Global fundamentals	**stockanalysis.com**, SEC **EDGAR**, **Financial Modeling Prep** free API

Build a comps table in Screener.in, then you can honestly say you understand the *workflow* — and add the **BMC certificate** to prove terminal literacy.

How it shows up in interviews

Q: "You need a quick trading-comps set for a listed FMCG company on Bloomberg — walk me through it." A: "I'd load the ticker with `<Equity><GO>`, open **DES** to confirm it's the right entity, then **RV** for the peer relative-value comps, or **EQS** to build a custom peer screen on sector, size and margin. To model it, I'd pull the same fields into Excel with `BDP` for current multiples and `BDH` for history, so the sheet refreshes."

Q: "Bloomberg vs Capital IQ — when do you reach for which?" A: "Bloomberg for live markets, fixed income, FX and news, and anything real-time. Capital IQ for deep screening, trading and precedent-transaction comps, and credit work — its Excel plug-in and precedent-transactions database are stronger for M&A modelling. FactSet sits between them and is best for portfolio analytics and polished tearsheets; Preqin for private-markets data neither of the others has."

Q: "You don't have a terminal — how do you keep your skills current?" A: "I completed **Bloomberg Market Concepts**, so I know the DES/FA/GP/EQS grammar and the `BDP` / `BDH` add-in. For live practice I use Screener.in and TradingView to build comps and screens, and NSE/BSE and MCA for filings — same workflow, no licence."

ATS keywords to add

Bloomberg Terminal, Bloomberg Market Concepts (BMC), BDP, BDH, BQL, DES, FA, EQS, Refinitiv Eikon, Refinitiv Workspace, LSEG, FactSet, S&P Capital IQ, CapIQ, CIQ Excel plug-in, Preqin, financial databases, trading comparables, precedent transactions, equity screening, comps analysis, market data, TradingView, Screener.in

Standards & Controls JDs Assume: US GAAP vs IFRS vs Ind AS, SOX/J-SOX, XBRL

The gap

Your bundles teach **Ind AS, Schedule III and month-end**. But GCC and MNC-controllership JDs assume you can *also* speak **US GAAP and IFRS**, operate inside a **SOX / J-SOX** control framework, and understand **XBRL/MCA** filing. Indian entities of US or Japanese parents keep two sets of books and run a formal controls regime — none of which your Ind-AS-first material covers. That crosswalk and that controls vocabulary are the gap.

Why companies ask for it

> **Real posting (HP, R2R, Bangalore):** "Highly skilled in US GAAP & IFRS … Ensure compliance with internal & SOX controls."
>
> **Real posting (Dentsu, Financial Control, Bangalore):** "IFRS + US GAAP; **J-SOX controls effectiveness attestation**; external audit support."

Every GCC controllership, R2R, financial-reporting and internal-audit role wants this because the India entity reports up to a parent on **US GAAP or IFRS** while filing locally on **Ind AS**, and a listed US parent is legally bound by **SOX** (Japanese parent → **J-SOX**). Roles: **R2R/RTR, financial reporting & consolidation, controllership, internal controls/SOX testing, statutory audit support** at HP, Dentsu, Accenture, Genpact, Deloitte/EY/PwC/KPMG managed services.

What "proficient" looks like

You can name the **standard number and the practical difference** across the three frameworks for the big-ticket areas; explain **design vs operating effectiveness** and walk a control from an **RCM** to a **test of one**; classify a control gap as a **deficiency / significant deficiency / material weakness**; and describe how Indian companies **XBRL-tag and file** with MCA.

How to actually learn/do it

US GAAP vs IFRS vs Ind AS — the crosswalk

Ind AS is *converged with* IFRS (so they're close, with carve-outs); **US GAAP is the different one**. Learn the deltas on the areas auditors and interviewers hammer:

Area	US GAAP	IFRS	Ind AS
Revenue	ASC 606	IFRS 15	Ind AS 115 — all 3 use the **5-step model**; substantially aligned
Leases	ASC 842 — lessee still splits **finance vs operating** (dual P&L model)	IFRS 16 — **single model**, almost all leases on balance sheet	Ind AS 116 — single model, follows IFRS 16
Financial instruments	ASC 326 **CECL** (lifetime expected loss, day 1)	IFRS 9 — **3-stage ECL** model	Ind AS 109 — 3-stage ECL, follows IFRS 9
Inventory	**LIFO permitted**; write-downs generally not reversed	LIFO **banned**; reversals allowed	LIFO banned; reversals allowed
Consolidation	VIE (variable interest) model	IFRS 10 single **control** model	Ind AS 110 control model
Dev. costs / R&D	Mostly **expensed**	**Capitalise** if IAS 38 criteria met	Capitalise (Ind AS 38)
Component depreciation	Not required	Required	Required
Extraordinary items	Prohibited	Prohibited	Prohibited

The two you must be able to speak to cold: **leases** (US GAAP keeps the operating/finance split; IFRS/Ind AS collapse it into one on-balance-sheet model) and **credit losses** (US **CECL** = lifetime loss from day one; IFRS/Ind AS **ECL** = staged, moves to lifetime only on significant deterioration).

Free study: the **IFRS Foundation** publishes standards summaries free; **MCA** hosts Ind AS free; **FASB** ASC Basic View is free; the Big-4 "**US GAAP vs IFRS**" comparison PDFs (EY, PwC, KPMG, Deloitte) are the single best crosswalk resource — download one.

Internal controls: SOX / J-SOX / IFC

- **SOX** (US Sarbanes-Oxley) **§302** = executives certify the financials; **§404** = management *and* the external auditor assess **internal control over financial reporting (ICFR)**.
- **J-SOX** = Japan's equivalent (Financial Instruments & Exchange Act) — same idea, management **attestation** of controls effectiveness (Dentsu's exact phrase).
- **IFC** = India's Internal Financial Controls over Financial Reporting under **Companies Act 2013 §143(3)(i)** — the auditor reports on IFC.

All rest on the **COSO 2013** framework (5 components, 17 principles).

The workflow you must know: 1. **RCM (Risk & Control Matrix)** — the master sheet listing each **risk → control → assertion → owner → frequency → test**. 2. **Design effectiveness** — is the control *capable* of preventing/detecting the risk? (walkthrough of one transaction). 3. **Operating effectiveness** — did it *actually operate* all year? (test a **sample** — e.g. 25 items for a daily control). 4. **Deficiency ladder:** a **control deficiency** < **significant deficiency** < **material weakness** (reasonable possibility of a material misstatement). 5. **Control types:** preventive vs detective, **manual vs automated**, and **ITGCs** (IT General Controls — access, change management, ops) that everything automated depends on.

Worked example: Risk = "unauthorised journal posted." Control = "all manual JEs >₹10 lakh require reviewer approval in SAP before posting." *Design test:* trace one JE — was approval captured? *Operating test:* pull 25 JEs from the year, confirm each has documented approver ≠ preparer. Two fail → evaluate: isolated slip (deficiency) or pervasive (significant/material).

XBRL & MCA filings

XBRL (eXtensible Business Reporting Language) tags each financial-statement number to a standard **taxonomy** element so regulators read it by machine. In India, specified companies file financials in XBRL with **MCA** via forms **AOC-4 XBRL** (and cost audit in **CRA-4**); you validate in the **MCA XBRL validation tool**, generate the instance document, do a **pre-scrutiny**, and upload. SEBI listed entities also file XBRL on the exchanges. You don't hand-code XBRL — you map the trial balance to taxonomy tags in the tool.

How it shows up in interviews

Q: "Biggest practical difference in lease accounting across US GAAP and IFRS?" A: "IFRS 16 and Ind AS 116 use a single lessee model — nearly every lease goes on the balance sheet as a right-of-use asset and lease liability, with depreciation plus interest. US GAAP's ASC 842 still splits operating vs finance leases: both go on the balance sheet, but operating leases keep a straight-line single lease expense in P&L rather than the front-loaded depreciation-plus-interest pattern. So EBITDA and expense geography differ."

Q: "Walk me through testing a SOX control." A: "I start from the RCM to get the control objective, assertion and frequency. First I test **design** with a walkthrough of one transaction to confirm the control can catch the risk. Then **operating effectiveness**: I pick a sample sized to frequency — say 25 for a daily control — and inspect evidence that it operated each time, like an approver different from the preparer. Exceptions get evaluated up the ladder from deficiency to significant deficiency to material weakness based on likelihood and magnitude."

Q: "What's the difference between SOX, J-SOX and IFC?" A: "Same concept — management/auditor assurance over financial-reporting controls, all built on COSO. SOX is US law for SEC registrants (§302 certification, §404 ICFR); J-SOX is Japan's version requiring management attestation of control effectiveness; IFC is India's, under Companies Act §143(3)(i), where the statutory auditor opines on internal financial controls."

ATS keywords to add

US GAAP, IFRS, Ind AS, ASC 606, IFRS 15, ASC 842, IFRS 16, IFRS 9, ECL, CECL, GAAP-to-IFRS reconciliation, SOX, Sarbanes-Oxley, J-SOX, §404, ICFR, IFC, Internal Financial Controls, COSO, Risk and Control Matrix (RCM), design and operating effectiveness, control testing, walkthrough, deficiency, significant deficiency, material weakness, ITGC, XBRL, AOC-4, MCA filing, statutory audit support, R2R

Regulatory & Statutory Reporting: Basel, FATCA/CRS, RBI/SEBI, AxiomSL/OneSumX

The gap

This is an entire, well-paid domain your six bundles skip. **Regulatory reporting** — the returns banks and financial institutions file with regulators on capital, liquidity, tax residency and transactions — is nothing like management MIS. It has its own standards (**Basel III/IV**), its own tax regimes (**FATCA/CRS**), its own regulator returns (**RBI, SEBI**), and its own dedicated software estate (**AxiomSL, OneSumX, Regnology, Moody's**). Learn the vocabulary and you unlock a market of GCC/BFSI jobs most candidates can't even read the JD for.

Why companies ask for it

> **Real posting (Luxoft, Finance Tech, Bangalore):** "Regulatory Reporting, General Ledger, Treasury, Liquidity Management, Capital Management, IFRS Reporting, **Basel Reporting** ... reg tools: **AxiomSL, Moody's, OneSumX, Regnology**, Oracle Financial Services."

Banks *must* file these returns — it's the law, and errors mean regulatory penalties — so the work is non-discretionary and recession-proof. Every foreign bank, GCC captive (JPMC, Deutsche, Barclays, UBS, HSBC, StanChart, Nomura, Wells Fargo) and consultancy (Luxoft, Capco, TCS, Accenture) staffs large **regulatory-reporting** teams in Mumbai, Bangalore, Pune and Hyderabad. Roles: **regulatory reporting analyst, Basel/RWA analyst, liquidity (LCR/NSFR) reporting, FinCrime/AML tech BA, statutory reporting, tax-operations (FATCA/CRS).** It pays a premium precisely because so few candidates understand it.

What "proficient" looks like

You can explain **what each return measures and why the regulator wants it**, trace a number from the **GL → data mart → reg-reporting engine → regulator submission**, and speak the platform vocabulary: what an **AxiomSL "run"** is, what **data lineage** and **adjustments** mean, and how validation/EBA-taxonomy filing works.

How to actually learn/do it

Basel III / IV — bank capital & liquidity

The global rulebook (from the Basel Committee, implemented in India via **RBI Master Directions**). Two families of ratios:

Ratio	Formula (essence)	Question it answers
CAR / CRAR	Capital ÷ **RWA** (risk-weighted assets), min ~9% (RBI) + buffers	Enough capital to absorb losses?
CET1	Common equity ÷ RWA	Highest-quality capital cushion
LCR	HQLA ÷ 30-day net cash outflows ≥ 100%	Survive a 30-day stress?
NSFR	Available ÷ Required stable funding ≥ 100%	Funding stable over 1 year?
Leverage ratio	Tier 1 ÷ total exposure	Backstop independent of risk weights

RWA is the heart of it: each asset gets a **risk weight** (a government bond ~0%, a mortgage ~35%, an unrated corporate ~100%) and RWA = exposure × weight, across **credit, market and operational** risk. **Basel IV** (RBI phasing in from 2025-26) tightens this with the **standardised output floor** capping how far internal models can lower RWA. Reports flow into RBI's **RBS/DSB returns** and, globally, EBA **COREP** (capital) and **FINREP** (financial) taxonomies.

FATCA / CRS — tax-residency reporting

- **FATCA** (US law) — financial institutions identify **US persons** and report their accounts (via the CBDT/IRS route in India).
- **CRS** (OECD Common Reporting Standard) — the multilateral version: identify account holders' **tax residencies** and report to their home tax authority. Operationally it's **self-certification, indicia search, and Form 61B** filing to the Indian income-tax department. Named on **tax-operations and KYC** JDs.

RBI & SEBI returns

- **RBI:** the **DSB (Off-site Surveillance) returns**, **RBS** (Risk-Based Supervision) data, CRR/SLR, priority-sector, and the **CIMS / XBRL** filing portal that replaced the old RBI XBRL site.
- **SEBI:** for AMCs/brokers/AIFs — periodic filings, **SCORES**, half-yearly and disclosure returns via exchange portals.

FEMA (corporate cross-border)

The exchange-control law behind foreign investment/borrowing filings — **FC-GPR** (shares issued to non-residents), **FC-TRS** (transfer), **ECB** returns, all now on the RBI **FIRMS** portal. Shows up on controllership JDs at companies with foreign shareholders.

The reg-reporting platforms

You won't buy these, but you must speak them:

Platform	Note
AxiomSL (ControllerView)	Market leader; ingests source data, applies rules, produces regulator-ready returns with full **lineage**
Wolters Kluwer OneSumX	Basel, liquidity, COREP/FINREP
Regnology (BearingPoint Abacus)	European Basel/statistical reporting
Moody's	Credit/regulatory analytics
Oracle Financial Services (OFSAA)	Analytics + reg reporting

How the workflow actually runs (AxiomSL mental model): source systems (GL, loans, deposits) → a **data-ingestion layer** (mapping, validation) → **business rules / classification** (assign risk weights, HQLA categories) → a **"run"** that produces the return → **validation rules** (regulator's edit checks) and **manual adjustments** with sign-off → **submission** in the regulator's format (XBRL/taxonomy). The BA's job is **data mapping, lineage, reconciliation** (report ties back to GL) and clearing validation breaks.

Free ways to build credibility (no licence needed): - Read the **RBI Master Direction on Basel III Capital** and one **RBI DSB return** format — both free on rbi.org.in. - Read the **EBA** COREP/FINREP overview (free). - Download a real bank's **Pillar 3 / Basel disclosures** (in every bank annual report) and read how CAR, LCR, NSFR and RWA are presented — that's the *output* of the whole machine. - Study the **Form 61B / CRS** guidance on the income-tax site. - Optional paid credentials that read well: **FRM** (GARP), or a "regulatory reporting" micro-course.

How it shows up in interviews

Q: "What does LCR measure and where does the data come from?" A: "LCR is High-Quality Liquid Assets divided by total net cash outflows over a 30-day stress, and it must be at least 100% — can the bank survive a month-long run without central-bank help. HQLA is mostly cash, central-bank reserves and government bonds; the outflows are stressed run-off rates on deposits and wholesale funding. The data comes from the deposit and treasury systems into the GL and the reg-reporting engine, where each item is bucketed by HQLA level and run-off rate."

Q: "Walk me through how a Basel capital return is produced in a tool like AxiomSL." A: "Source data — loans, exposures, collateral, ratings — is ingested and mapped to the reporting model. Business rules assign each exposure its asset class and risk weight to compute RWA across credit, market and operational risk. A run aggregates capital over RWA to produce CET1, Tier 1 and CAR, populates the return, then validation rules — the regulator's edit checks — flag breaks. We reconcile the total back to the GL, book any approved adjustments with sign-off, and submit in the required taxonomy. Throughout, lineage lets us trace any reported number back to source."

Q: "FATCA vs CRS?" A: "Both report financial-account information for tax purposes. FATCA is US-specific — identify and report US persons' accounts. CRS is the OECD multilateral standard covering all participating jurisdictions — you determine each holder's tax residencies and report to their home authorities. In India both run on customer self-certification and indicia checks, filed to the income-tax department via Form 61B."

ATS keywords to add

Regulatory reporting, Basel III, Basel IV, CAR, CRAR, CET1, RWA, risk-weighted assets, LCR, NSFR, liquidity reporting, capital adequacy, COREP, FINREP, Pillar 3, FATCA, CRS, Form 61B, RBI returns, DSB returns, RBS, CIMS, SEBI reporting, FEMA, FC-GPR, FC-TRS, ECB reporting, AxiomSL, OneSumX, Regnology, Moody's, OFSAA, data lineage, data mapping, reconciliation, statutory reporting

AML/KYC & Financial-Crime Tooling: World-Check, Actimize, SAS, Quantexa, Napier

The gap

The career bundle decoded *what* a KYC/AML analyst role is and why banks hire for it. What it does **not** teach is the actual **tooling and casework** — the screening engines, transaction-monitoring platforms, alert and case managers, and the regulatory filing chain that every JD names by product. When Luxoft asks for "NICE Actimize, SAS AML, Oracle FCCM, Quantexa, Napier AI, ComplyAdvantage, Refinitiv World-Check" and Citi asks for "screening, negative news, ACAMS," they are asking whether you can *operate the machinery*, not whether you understand the concept. That machinery is the gap.

Why companies ask for it

> Real posting (Luxoft, Bangalore): "AML Transaction Monitoring, CDD, KYC, Sanctions Screening, Fraud Detection, Case Management, Customer Risk Rating." Named tools: "NICE Actimize, FICO TONBELLER, SAS AML, Quantexa, Oracle FCCM, Napier AI, ComplyAdvantage, Refinitiv World-Check."
>
> Real posting (Citi, KYC): "screening, negative news, ACAMS."

These roles sit in three buckets: (1) **KYC/CDD analysts** at banks and GCCs (Citi, HSBC, Deutsche, Standard Chartered's Chennai/Bangalore hubs) who onboard and periodically review customers; (2) **AML transaction-monitoring / investigations analysts** who work alerts and file suspicious-transaction reports; and (3) **financial-crime technology / RegTech** roles (Luxoft, Cognizant, TCS BaNCS) who *configure and tune* the detection engines rather than clear alerts. India is the global back-office for all three — most Tier-1 banks run their financial-crime operations from GCCs here.

What "proficient" looks like

An employer tests whether you can:

- Run a **name screen** against a sanctions/PEP list, read a hit, and clear it as a true or false positive with a documented rationale (fuzzy-match logic, secondary identifiers like DOB/nationality).
- Take a **transaction-monitoring alert**, pull the customer's profile and transaction history, decide "clear vs escalate," and write a defensible investigation narrative.
- Build a **Customer Risk Rating (CRR)** from the standard factors: geography, product, channel, customer type, PEP status.
- Know the **CDD → EDD** trigger points and the **SAR/STR filing** chain end-to-end.
- Speak the vocabulary of at least one named platform (Actimize, SAS, FCCM) — screens, alert queues, case lifecycle.

How to actually learn/do it

1. The CDD/EDD spine (RBI, free). Read the **RBI Master Direction – KYC (2016, updated 2024)**. Learn the three tiers of due diligence: - **CDD** — identity, beneficial ownership, purpose of relationship, on every customer. - **EDD** — extra scrutiny for high-risk: PEPs, high-risk geographies, correspondent banking, complex ownership. Triggered by CRR or a red flag. - **Ongoing monitoring** — periodic review, frequency driven by risk band (high-risk yearly, low-risk every 8–10 yrs).

2. Sanctions & PEP screening — the logic. Screening tools (**Refinitiv World-Check**, **Dow Jones Risk & Compliance**, **FircoSoft/Fircosoft Continuity**) hold curated lists: OFAC SDN, UN, EU, UK HMT, MHA India, plus PEP and adverse-media databases. The engine does **fuzzy matching** — phonetic (Soundex/Metaphone), edit-distance, transliteration — so "Mohammed" matches "Muhamad." Your job on a hit: compare **secondary identifiers** (DOB, nationality, passport) to discount false positives. Worked example: an alert fires on customer *Rajesh Kumar* against a World-Check PEP *Rajesh Kumar* — you check DOB (1978 vs 1955) and country (India vs Fiji) → **discount as false positive**, document, close.

3. Transaction monitoring. Engines (**NICE Actimize SAM**, **SAS AML**, **Oracle FCCM/Mantas**, **Quantexa**, **Napier AI**, **ComplyAdvantage**) run **scenarios/rules** against transaction data: structuring (many sub-threshold cash deposits), rapid movement of funds, round-tripping, dormant-then-active accounts. Each hit becomes an **alert** in a queue. **Quantexa** and **Napier** add **entity resolution / network analytics** — linking accounts by shared phone/address/device to surface hidden networks, the "next-gen" pitch vs rule-based legacy. Your workflow: pick up alert → review triggering transactions + customer KYC → decide **clear / escalate to case** → if escalated, investigate and recommend a filing.

4. Case management & filing. Escalated alerts become **cases**. In India, a suspicious transaction goes as an **STR (Suspicious Transaction Report)** to **FIU-IND** (Financial Intelligence Unit) via the **FINnet/FINGate** portal, under the **PMLA 2002**. Also know **CTR** (cash > ₹10 lakh) and **CCR** (counterfeit currency). Globally the equivalent is a **SAR** to FinCEN (US) or the NCA (UK). Learn the **narrative discipline**: who, what, when, how much, why suspicious, what action recommended.

5. Free ways to practise. - **FATF** 40 Recommendations + the India Mutual Evaluation Report (2024) — the global rulebook, free. - **RBI KYC Master Direction** and **FIU-IND** website (STR/CTR formats, red-flag indicators) — free. - **ACAMS** publishes free webinars and a glossary; the **CAMS** certification (~USD 1,995) is the resume gold standard — self-study the syllabus even if you delay the exam. - **ComplyAdvantage** and **Napier** run free blogs/webinars that walk their screens — good for vocabulary. - Build a mock CRR scorecard in Excel (you already know Excel) — weight geography/product/channel/customer, output Low/Med/High.

How it shows up in interviews

Q: "You get a sanctions screening hit on a customer. Walk me through what you do." A: "First I confirm it's a *potential* match, not a confirmed one — screening is fuzzy. I compare secondary identifiers: full name, date of birth, nationality, and any ID numbers against the list entry. If they diverge — different DOB, different country — I discount it as a false positive with a documented rationale and close it. If they align, I don't clear it; I escalate to L2/compliance, freeze or hold the transaction per policy, and it may lead to an STR. The golden rule is never clear a true sanctions hit at analyst level."

Q: "Difference between CDD and EDD, and what triggers EDD?" A: "CDD is the baseline done on every customer — verifying identity, beneficial ownership, and purpose. EDD is deeper scrutiny for higher-risk relationships: source of funds/wealth, senior-management sign-off, more frequent review. It's triggered by the customer risk rating — PEP status, high-risk jurisdiction, correspondent banking, cash-intensive business, or complex/opaque ownership structures."

Q: "What's a false positive and why do they matter in AML?" A: "A false positive is an alert or screening hit that turns out not to be genuinely suspicious. They matter because monitoring systems generate huge volumes — often 90%+ of alerts are false positives — so the operational challenge is tuning scenarios and thresholds to cut noise without missing true risk. That's where entity-resolution tools like Quantexa or Napier add value over pure rules."

ATS keywords to add

KYC, CDD, EDD, AML, sanctions screening, PEP screening, adverse media / negative news, transaction monitoring, Customer Risk Rating (CRR), name screening, false-positive reduction, alert investigation, case management, SAR, STR, CTR, FIU-IND, PMLA, FATF, RBI KYC Master Direction, OFAC, NICE Actimize, SAS AML, Oracle FCCM, Quantexa, Napier AI, ComplyAdvantage, Refinitiv World-Check, Dow Jones Risk & Compliance, FircoSoft, entity resolution, ACAMS / CAMS.

ESG & Sustainability Reporting: BRSR, GRI, TCFD, CSRD

The gap

ESG reporting is one of the fastest-growing 2026 finance asks in India, and it is **completely absent** from the six bundles — they teach Ind AS, Schedule III, GST and modelling, but nothing about the parallel **non-financial disclosure regime** that listed companies, Big-4 assurance teams and rating houses now staff for. This gap is real because the mandate is real: SEBI requires the **top 1,000 listed companies by market cap** to file the **BRSR** (Business Responsibility and Sustainability Report), and from FY24 the **BRSR Core** carries **mandatory reasonable assurance** on a phased basis. A finance grad who can read a BRSR and speak GRI/TCFD is immediately useful to teams that are hiring faster than they can train.

Why companies ask for it

> Real posting (Dentsu Financial Control, Bangalore): finance controllers now own "KPI dashboards" and external-audit support that increasingly extend to sustainability metrics; and across 2026, Big-4 and listed-company teams have opened dedicated **ESG / sustainability reporting** and **ESG assurance** roles.

The hirers cluster into four groups: (1) **Big 4 ESG / sustainability assurance** practices (EY, Deloitte, PwC, KPMG) — the biggest volume, doing BRSR assurance and readiness; (2) **listed-company sustainability / ESG reporting teams** inside the CFO or company-secretary function, who compile the BRSR; (3) **rating & analytics** shops (MSCI ESG, Sustainalytics, CRISIL/CareEdge ESG, ICRA) who score companies; and (4) **consulting / carbon-accounting** advisory. For a commerce/finance background this is a rare *open door* — the field is young, so the barrier is knowledge of the frameworks, not years of experience.

What "proficient" looks like

An employer tests whether you can:

- Explain **what the BRSR is, who must file, and its structure** (9 principles of the NGRBC, three sections).
- Distinguish **BRSR vs BRSR Core** and know what **assurance** means for each.
- Map the **global alphabet soup** — GRI, SASB, TCFD, ISSB (IFRS S1/S2), EU CSRD — and how they relate.
- Understand **Scope 1/2/3 emissions** and basic **carbon accounting** (activity data × emission factor).
- Read an **ESG score** (MSCI, Sustainalytics) and explain what drives it and what **greenwashing** risk looks like.

How to actually learn/do it

1. BRSR — the India core (free, do this first). Download the **SEBI BRSR format** (LODR circular) and one real filed BRSR from a large company (Infosys, Reliance, HUL — all on their investor sites). Learn the structure: - **Section A — General disclosures** (entity details, employees, CSR, holdings). - **Section B — Management & process** (policies mapped to the **9 NGRBC principles** — ethics, product safety, employee wellbeing, stakeholders, human rights, environment, policy advocacy, inclusive growth, consumer value). - **Section C — Principle-wise performance** (the quantitative KPIs — energy, water, emissions, waste, diversity, safety).

2. BRSR Core & assurance. BRSR Core is a subset of ~**9 key ESG attributes** with defined **KPIs and intensity ratios** (e.g. GHG intensity per rupee of turnover) that must carry **reasonable assurance** by an independent assurance provider — phased from the top 150 companies (FY24) widening down the top 1,000. This is what the Big-4 assurance roles execute: gathering evidence, testing data lineage, issuing the assurance statement. Also know **value-chain disclosure** (BRSR Core extends to top upstream/downstream partners).

3. Global frameworks — the map.

Framework	Owner	What it is	Focus
GRI	Global Reporting Initiative	Most-used voluntary standard	Impact on world (double materiality)
SASB	now under ISSB	Industry-specific financial-materiality metrics	Investor-focused
TCFD	FSB (now folded into ISSB)	Climate risk in 4 pillars	Governance/Strategy/Risk/Metrics
ISSB (IFRS S1/S2)	IFRS Foundation	Global baseline; S1 general, S2 climate	Financial materiality
EU CSRD / ESRS	EU	Mandatory EU + large non-EU subsidiaries	Double materiality, assured

Key relationships: **TCFD's four pillars** live on inside **IFRS S2**; **ISSB** is becoming the global baseline that BRSR and CSRD interoperate with; **CSRD** catches Indian companies with material EU operations, so exporters care.

4. Carbon accounting basics. The **GHG Protocol** splits emissions into **Scope 1** (direct — own boilers, vehicles), **Scope 2** (purchased electricity), **Scope 3** (value chain — the biggest and hardest). Core formula: **emissions = activity data × emission factor** (e.g. kWh × grid emission factor from CEA India). Tiny worked example: 1,000,000 kWh grid power × 0.71 tCO_2e/MWh ≈ **710 tCO_2e** Scope 2.

5. Scores & greenwashing. MSCI ESG rates AAA–CCC; **Sustainalytics** gives a *risk* score (lower = better, unmanaged risk). Both are largely **disclosure- and controversy-driven**. **Greenwashing** = claims unsupported by data; SEBI and the ASCI now police it. Learn to spot vague claims ("carbon neutral" with no scope defined, no baseline, no assurance).

6. Free ways to learn + certifications. Free: **SEBI BRSR circulars**, **GRI Standards** (free download), **GHG Protocol** corporate standard, **TCFD final recommendations**, **IFRS S1/S2** basis for conclusions. Certifications that carry weight: **GRI Certified Professional**, **CFA Institute Certificate in ESG Investing** (the strongest single credential for Indian finance grads, ~USD 790), **SASB/FSA credential**, and Big-4 ESG academies. Build a portfolio piece: take one company's BRSR and write a 2-page critique mapping its Section C KPIs to GRI and flagging any greenwashing.

How it shows up in interviews

Q: "What is the BRSR and who has to file it?" A: "The Business Responsibility and Sustainability Report is SEBI's mandatory ESG disclosure for the **top 1,000 listed companies by market capitalisation**, filed as part of the annual report. It's built on the nine NGRBC principles and has three sections — general disclosures, management approach, and principle-wise quantitative performance. A subset called **BRSR Core** — nine key attributes with defined KPIs — requires **reasonable assurance**, phased in from the largest companies."

Q: "Explain Scope 1, 2 and 3 emissions." A: "Scope 1 is direct emissions from sources a company owns or controls — company vehicles, on-site fuel. Scope 2 is indirect from purchased energy, mainly electricity. Scope 3 is all other value-chain emissions — purchased goods, business travel, use of sold products — usually the largest and hardest to measure because it needs supplier data. BRSR Core and ISSB S2 push companies toward Scope 3 disclosure."

Q: "How do GRI, TCFD and ISSB relate?" A: "GRI is impact-focused with double materiality — how the company affects the world. TCFD is climate-specific, structured in four pillars, and has now been absorbed into the ISSB's IFRS S2. ISSB (S1 and S2) is the emerging global baseline focused on financial materiality for investors. In practice companies report against GRI for stakeholders and ISSB/BRSR for regulators and investors, and the frameworks are converging."

ATS keywords to add

BRSR, BRSR Core, SEBI LODR, NGRBC, ESG reporting, sustainability reporting, GRI Standards, SASB, TCFD, ISSB, IFRS S1, IFRS S2, EU CSRD, ESRS, double materiality, GHG Protocol, Scope 1/2/3 emissions, carbon accounting, emission factors, ESG assurance, reasonable assurance, MSCI ESG, Sustainalytics, greenwashing, materiality assessment, CFA Certificate in ESG Investing, GRI Certified Professional.

AI & GenAI in Finance (2026): Copilots, LLMs, Agents, Governance

The gap

The bundles cover "AI & automation" at a general level and teach Python/pandas automation. What they do **not** cover is the **2026 GenAI-in-finance reality** that JDs now explicitly demand: the **Copilots** embedded in the tools you already use (Excel, Power BI, M365), **LLMs** used daily for research, commentary and code, **agentic automation** (Genpact's "AI Gigafactory," Accenture, Citi), the **prompt skill** that separates useful from dangerous output, and — most importantly for a finance role — the **governance, model-risk and hallucination controls** without which no bank lets you touch this. This is the gap because "used ChatGPT" is not a skill; *operating GenAI safely on financial data with controls* is.

Why companies ask for it

> Real posting (Genpact, FP&A/R2R): a company-wide push on **"AI Gigafactory / agentic AI."**
>
> Earlier 2026 JDs: Accenture and Citi emphasise **agentic AI** and GenAI copilots; "multiple 2026 JDs emphasise AI/GenAI and GCC shared-services."

Every finance function is being asked to do more with the same headcount, and GenAI is the lever. The roles that name it: **FP&A analysts** (faster commentary, variance narratives), **R2R/controllers** (reconciliation triage, journal narratives), **transformation / finance-tech** teams building agents, and **GCC delivery** roles where "productivity via AI" is now a KPI. Employers are not looking for prompt engineers — they want finance people who **use these tools competently and know the guardrails.**

What "proficient" looks like

An employer tests whether you can:

- Use **Copilot inside Excel and Power BI** to generate formulas, DAX, summaries and charts from a natural-language ask — and **verify** the output.
- Use an **LLM** to draft variance commentary, write/debug **SQL and DAX**, summarise long documents, and structure analysis — with disciplined prompting.
- Explain **agentic automation** — the difference between a chatbot, a copilot, and an autonomous agent that chains steps and calls tools.
- Articulate **AI governance**: hallucination risk, data-confidentiality rules, human-in-the-loop review, model risk, and why you never paste client data into a public model.

How to actually learn/do it

1. Copilots in the tools you already know. - **Excel Copilot (M365 Copilot):** in a table, open the Copilot pane and type "add a column flagging variances over 10%," "summarise this data," or "suggest a PivotTable." It writes the formula/PivotTable — you **check it**. Great for boilerplate; wrong often enough that verification is mandatory. - **Power BI Copilot:** in the report view, "create a page analysing sales by region," or ask it to

write a DAX measure ("YoY revenue growth %") or **explain an existing measure**. It also drafts narrative summaries of a visual. - **M365 Copilot for finance:** summarise a 40-page board pack, draft an email from a variance table, generate a first-cut PowerPoint from an Excel model. - **Free alternatives:** you don't need a paid Copilot licence to build the skill. Use **ChatGPT / Claude / Gemini free tiers** to draft the same DAX/SQL/formulas, then paste into desktop Power BI / Excel. The skill transfers.

2. LLMs for real finance tasks — with good prompting. The prompt pattern that works: **Role + Context + Task + Format + Constraints.** Worked example for FP&A commentary:

> "You are an FP&A analyst. Here is the Q2 variance table [paste]. Write 4 bullet points of management commentary explaining the biggest drivers of the unfavourable opex variance. Be specific, use the numbers, no speculation beyond the data."

Other daily uses: **write SQL** ("join these two tables, monthly revenue by customer"), **debug DAX**, **explain a regulation** in plain English, **reconciliation triage** (paste two lists, ask for likely mismatches), **build an Excel formula** from a description. Always: **give it the data structure, ask for its assumptions, and verify.**

3. Agentic automation (the 2026 buzzword decoded). - **Chatbot** = answers questions. - **Copilot** = assists inside an app, human drives. - **Agent** = given a goal, it **plans steps, calls tools/APIs, and acts** with limited human checkpoints. Genpact's "AI Gigafactory" and Accenture's agentic pitch mean: an agent that, say, pulls the trial balance, runs reconciliations, drafts the journal, and flags exceptions for a human to approve. You don't have to build these, but you must **explain the concept and where human-in-the-loop sits.** Free way to grasp it: read about **Microsoft Copilot Studio agents** and **LangChain/AutoGen** concepts (no need to code them).

4. Governance, model risk & hallucination controls — the part that gets you hired. This is where finance credibility lives: - **Never paste confidential/client/PII data into a public LLM.** Enterprises use walled deployments (Azure OpenAI, private endpoints) precisely for this. - **Hallucination:** LLMs fabricate plausible numbers and citations. Rule: **the model drafts, the human owns.** Every figure is traced to source. - **Human-in-the-loop:** any agent action with financial impact needs a review/approval gate — tie it to your **SOX/internal-controls** knowledge (four-eyes principle). - **Model risk:** connect to model-validation vocabulary (the Acuity Model Risk JD) — versioning, testing, monitoring for drift, documentation. - **Auditability:** prompts and outputs logged; explainability for regulators.

5. What to put on a resume — honestly. Do **not** write "AI/ML engineer." Do write, truthfully: "Used **Excel/Power BI Copilot** and LLMs to automate variance commentary and DAX/SQL generation, cutting reporting time by X%, with human review controls." Claim *use with judgment*, not model-building.

How it shows up in interviews

Q: "How have you used GenAI in a finance task?" A: "I use it as a fast first-drafter with verification. For monthly reporting I feed the variance table to an LLM with a structured prompt — role, the actual numbers, the format I want — to draft commentary, which I then edit and fact-check against source. I also use it to write and debug DAX and SQL. The productivity gain is real, but I treat every output as a draft I own, never a final answer."

Q: "What are the risks of using LLMs on financial data, and how do you control them?" A: "Three main risks: **confidentiality** — never put client or PII data into a public model, use an enterprise walled deployment; **hallucination** — models invent plausible-but-wrong figures, so every number must trace to source and a human signs off; and **auditability** — in a controlled environment prompts and outputs should be logged. It maps cleanly onto existing SOX controls — the model is like a junior analyst whose work you always review under a four-eyes principle."

Q: "What does 'agentic AI' mean and where's the risk?" A: "An agent is given a goal and autonomously plans and executes steps — calling tools and APIs — rather than just answering. In finance that might be pulling data, running a reconciliation, and drafting journals. The risk is autonomous action without oversight, so the control is human-in-the-loop approval gates on anything with financial impact, plus logging and clear ownership. The value is throughput; the discipline is governance."

ATS keywords to add

GenAI, generative AI, LLM, Microsoft 365 Copilot, Excel Copilot, Power BI Copilot, Copilot Studio, prompt engineering, ChatGPT / Claude / Gemini, Azure OpenAI, agentic AI, AI agents, human-in-the-loop, AI governance, model risk, hallucination controls, responsible AI, RAG (retrieval-augmented generation), finance automation, AI-assisted reporting, natural-language querying, DAX/SQL generation, data confidentiality, auditability.

How GCC/Shared-Services Finance Actually Runs: R2R/P2P/O2C, WD-Close, SLAs, RPA, SOPs

The gap

Most India finance jobs in 2026 sit inside a **GCC** (Global Capability Centre) or **BPO/GBS** (Global Business Services) shared-services centre — Genpact, Accenture, HP, Cromwell, Dentsu, and hundreds of captive centres in Bangalore, Hyderabad, Gurugram, Pune. These run finance as a **factory** organised into *process towers* with *service-level agreements*, *working-day close calendars*, *ticketing queues*, and *desktop procedures*. Your bundles teach the accounting (Ind AS, month-end, reconciliations) but not the **operating model** the accounting runs inside. Interviewers screen hard on this vocabulary because it tells them whether you'll survive the floor from day one.

Why companies ask for it

> Real posting (HP, Bangalore R2R): "R2R, AR & P2P … Ensure compliance with internal & SOX controls … Automate data workflows."
>
> Real posting (Genpact, FP&A/R2R): "Record-to-Report" delivery inside a shared-services engagement, with a company-wide push on "AI Gigafactory / agentic AI."

Every captive and BPO finance role — R2R analyst, P2P/AP specialist, O2C/collections analyst, general-ledger accountant, close lead, process SME, transition manager — is defined by which **tower** it belongs to and which **SLAs** it owns. Get the model and you speak their language in the first five minutes.

What "proficient" looks like

The bar is that you can, unprompted, do the following:

- Name the three core towers and what each **owns end-to-end**.
- Explain a **WD1–WD5+ close calendar** and where a given task lands.
- Distinguish an **SLA** (a promise, e.g. 98% invoices posted in 2 days) from a **KPI** (a measured metric, e.g. days-to-close) and quote a couple of each.
- Describe how **SOP / DTP** documents are structured and why they matter for audit and transition.
- Explain a **transition/migration** (as-is → to-be, knowledge transfer, parallel run, go-live, hypercare).
- Say where **RPA** (UiPath, Automation Anywhere, Blue Prism) and **ticketing** (ServiceNow) fit.

How to actually learn/do it

The three process towers. Memorise these cold.

Tower	Full name	Owns end-to-end	Core sub-processes
R2R	Record-to-Report	The general ledger and the financial statements	Journals, accruals/prepayments, intercompany, fixed assets, bank & balance-sheet **reconciliations**, month-end close, MIS/reporting, SOX
P2P	Procure-to-Pay (a.k.a. Purchase-to-Pay, AP)	Buying and paying suppliers	Requisition → PO → goods receipt → invoice → **3-way match** → payment run → vendor master, aging
O2C	Order-to-Cash (a.k.a. Quote-to-Cash, AR)	Selling and collecting cash	Order → credit check → billing/invoice → **cash application** → collections/dunning → dispute/deduction → DSO

Two supporting towers you should also name: **FP&A** (budget/forecast/variance) and **Treasury** (cash, banking, FX). "Hire-to-Retire" (H2R, payroll) sometimes sits in finance too.

The working-day close calendar. The close is run against *working days*, not calendar dates, so it survives weekends/holidays. WD0 is the last day of the month. A stylised R2R calendar:

Day	Activity
WD1	Sub-ledgers cut off; AP/AR post final invoices; FX rates loaded
WD2	Accruals & prepayments; intercompany matching; fixed-asset depreciation run
WD3	**Balance-sheet reconciliations**; flux/variance analysis
WD4	Review, sign-offs, **commentary** for the BS/close call
WD5	Ledger close, consolidation, MIS pack issued

Learn to answer "what happens on WD2?" instantly — it is a classic screen.

SLAs vs KPIs. Practise a few numbers you can defend: invoice posting SLA 95–98% within 48 hrs; PO-backed invoice touchless rate; close in WD5; unapplied-cash %; DSO/DPO; recon completeness and **aged open items > 90 days**; SLA **green/amber/red** RAG status reported weekly.

SOP / DTP. An SOP (Standard Operating Procedure) is the high-level "what/why"; a **DTP (Desktop Procedure)** is the click-by-click "how" — screenshots of the exact SAP/Oracle screens, T-codes, who approves, what the control is. When work moves to a GCC it *cannot* migrate without DTPs. Free practice: write a one-page DTP for a task you know (e.g. "post a manual accrual journal") with purpose, frequency, inputs, step-by-step screens, control point, and RACI.

Transitions/migrations. The lifecycle: *as-is study → to-be design → Knowledge Transfer (KT) → parallel run/shadow → go-live → hypercare (30–90 days of extra support) → steady state (BAU)*. Deliverables: process maps, DTPs, a **RACI**, a cutover plan. This is the single most valued phrase-set for anyone above analyst.

RPA in finance. You don't need to code a bot, but know the shape. A **UiPath** bot logs into SAP, downloads a report, opens Excel, reformats, and emails it — replacing a "swivel-chair" manual task. Vendors: **UiPath, Automation Anywhere, Blue Prism**. Good candidates: bank-statement download, recon prep, invoice data entry, report distribution. Terms: *attended vs unattended bot, orchestrator, bot runner, human-in-the-loop*. Free practice: the **UiPath Community Edition** and free Academy give a real certificate; build one bot that reads an Excel and writes a summary.

Ticketing & controls. Work arrives as **tickets/cases** in **ServiceNow** (or Jira). Learn queue, priority (P1–P4), SLA clock, and *first-time-right*. Controls: **SOX / J-SOX** control testing, **maker-checker (four-eyes)**, segregation of duties, and the **RCM** (Risk & Control Matrix).

How it shows up in interviews

Q: "Walk me through the P2P process end-to-end and where the key control is." "Requisition raised and approved → PO issued → goods/services received and a GRN posted → supplier invoice arrives → the system performs a **3-way match** of PO, GRN and invoice within tolerance → if matched it's parked for payment, if not it's routed to a resolution queue → payment run releases it, and I update the vendor aging. The critical control is the 3-way match plus **maker-checker** on the payment run, which is a SOX control because it prevents duplicate or fraudulent payments."

Q: "It's WD3 and a balance-sheet recon won't tie — a ₹4 lakh unreconciled item. What do you do?" "I quantify and age it, check whether it's timing (in-transit, unposted accrual) or a genuine difference, trace it to source, and post a correcting or accrual journal with backup. If I can't clear it by cut-off I log it on the recon with an owner and a resolution date, flag it in the WD4 commentary, and escalate anything above the materiality threshold so the BS call isn't surprised."

Q: "What makes a transition successful?" "Complete DTPs and process maps before KT, a proper parallel run so we catch gaps while the retained team still owns it, a clear RACI, defined SLAs from go-live, and a real hypercare window. Success is measured by SLA attainment and error rate reaching steady state without the client re-absorbing work."

ATS keywords to add

Record-to-Report (R2R), Procure-to-Pay (P2P), Order-to-Cash (O2C), General Ledger, month-end close, working-day close calendar (WD1–WD5), balance-sheet reconciliations, three-way match, cash application, DSO/DPO, SLA/KPI management, RAG reporting, SOP/DTP documentation, transitions and migrations, knowledge transfer (KT), hypercare, RACI, Global Capability Centre (GCC), shared services / GBS, RPA (UiPath, Automation Anywhere, Blue Prism), ServiceNow, SOX/J-SOX controls, maker-checker, Risk & Control Matrix (RCM), process improvement, first-time-right.

Treasury & Cash Tech: TMS (Kyriba/SAP TRM), FX Hedging, Liquidity, SWIFT/Settlements

The gap

Your bundles decode *what a treasury role is*; they don't teach the **plumbing** treasury runs on. Corporate and bank treasury JDs in 2026 want the **systems** (a Treasury Management System — Kyriba, SAP TRM, FIS), the **FX-hedging mechanics** (forwards, swaps, and enough **hedge accounting** to survive an audit), **liquidity/cash positioning**, and the **bank connectivity** layer (SWIFT, MT/MX messages, settlements and confirmations). None of that is in DCF/modelling or the treasury career decode — it's operational treasury tech, and it's a gap.

Why companies ask for it

> Real posting (Dentsu, Bangalore Financial Control): "... treasury, Insurance, **Hedging FX exposure** ..."
>
> Real posting (Intel, Treasury): "settlements, **TMS/SAP HANA**, KYC/AML, money markets."

Roles: corporate treasury analyst/manager, GCC treasury-ops, bank middle/back office, treasury tech/implementation (Luxoft-style), and FP&A roles that own FX. JPMorgan/Citi/Intel-type treasury desks and every GCC treasury tower expect this.

What "proficient" looks like

You can produce a **daily cash position**, decide a short-term investment or borrowing, explain why a company hedges a specific FX exposure and how a **forward** neutralises it, describe what a **TMS** automates versus spreadsheets, and trace a payment from instruction to settlement via **SWIFT**. You know the vocabulary of **hedge accounting** (cash-flow vs fair-value hedge, hedge effectiveness, OCI) without pretending to be an IFRS-9 specialist.

How to actually learn/do it

The daily cash position. The core treasury deliverable. Pull opening bank balances (via bank portal or SWIFT statement), layer expected inflows (AR collections) and outflows (payroll, AP runs, tax, debt service), and compute the **closing position per currency per bank**. Surplus → invest (money-market fund, fixed deposit, commercial paper); deficit → draw on a revolving credit facility or intercompany loan. Free practice: build a 5-bank, 3-currency cash-position sheet in Excel with an opening balance, dated flows, and a target minimum buffer.

Liquidity structures & the in-house bank. Learn **cash pooling**: *physical/zero-balancing* (funds physically swept to a header account nightly) vs *notional pooling* (balances offset for interest without moving cash). An **in-house bank (IHB)** makes one treasury entity act as banker to all subsidiaries — running **intercompany loans**, netting, and a **payment factory** ("**POBO/COBO**" — payments/collections on behalf of). These are the exact phrases treasury-transformation JDs use.

Treasury Management Systems. A TMS is the system of record for cash, debt, investments, and hedges. Know the leaders and what they do:

TMS	Notes
Kyriba	Cloud market leader — cash management, payments hub, bank connectivity, risk
SAP TRM / S/4HANA Treasury	SAP shops; deep GL integration; "TRM-HANA" in the Intel JD
FIS Quantum / Integrity	Large corporates and banks
ION / Reval, GTreasury	Also common

What a TMS actually does that a spreadsheet can't: auto-imports bank statements, forecasts cash, books and revalues deals, generates **hedge-accounting** entries, connects to banks for payments, and gives an audit trail. Free/low-cost practice: watch vendor product demos and read Kyriba/SAP TRM datasheets so you can *speak the modules* (Cash Management, Payments, FX/Risk, In-House Banking).

FX hedging mechanics. The building blocks:

- **Forward contract** — lock a rate today for a future date. If you'll receive USD 1m in 90 days and fear the rupee strengthening, you *sell USD forward*; the forward rate reflects the interest-rate differential (**forward points**), not a forecast.
- **FX swap** — spot leg + offsetting forward leg; used to roll positions and manage funding across currencies.
- **Option** — right not obligation; pay a premium for downside protection with upside retained.
- **Natural hedge / netting** — offset a USD payable against a USD receivable before hedging the residual.

Tiny worked example: exporter expects **USD 1,000,000 in 90 days**, spot 83.00, 90-day forward 83.60. Selling forward locks ₹8.36 crore regardless of where spot lands. If spot falls to 82.00 at maturity, the hedge saved ₹1.6m versus being unhedged; if spot rises to 84.50, you "lost" upside — but treasury's job is *certainty*, not speculation.

Hedge accounting basics (enough to not fail an audit). Under **IFRS 9 / Ind AS 109**: a **cash-flow hedge** (hedging a forecast transaction) parks the effective portion of the derivative's gain/loss in **OCI** and recycles it to P&L when the hedged item hits; a **fair-value hedge** runs both through P&L. You must document **hedge designation** and test **effectiveness**. You don't need to build the model — you need to say those words correctly.

Money markets. Know the short-end instruments treasury touches: **T-bills, commercial paper (CP), certificates of deposit (CD), repos, money-market funds**, and India's overnight benchmarks — **MIBOR** and the tri-party repo (**TREPS**). Globally, **SOFR** replaced LIBOR.

Bank connectivity & settlements. Payments and statements move over **SWIFT**. Legacy **MT** messages are migrating to **ISO 20022 MX** (the 2025 CBPR+ cutover): **MT103** (single customer payment) → **pacs.008**; **MT202** (bank-to-bank) → **pacs.009**; **MT940/MT942** (end-of-day/intraday statements) feed the TMS. India's rails: **RTGS/NEFT** and **UPI**. **Settlement** = the actual movement of funds on value date; a **confirmation** (via SWIFT or platforms like MarkitWire/DTCC) is the two counterparties agreeing trade terms — the middle/back-office matching step. **Nostro/vostro** accounts and **reconciliation** of them is core back-office work. **Bank Account Management (BAM)** — opening/closing accounts, **KYC** refresh, and maintaining signatories — is increasingly its own JD line.

How it shows up in interviews

Q: "An exporter will receive USD 1m in three months and is worried about the rupee. How do you hedge?" "Sell USD 1m forward for 90 days, which locks the rupee value at the forward rate — spot adjusted for the interest-rate differential. That removes uncertainty; we're not taking a view on direction. I'd first net any USD payables in that window and only hedge the residual exposure, per the hedging policy."

Q: "What does a TMS give you that Excel doesn't?" "Automated bank-statement import via SWIFT, a real-time multi-bank multi-currency cash position, deal capture with revaluation, straight-through payments, auto-generated hedge-accounting entries, and a full audit trail with segregation of duties. Excel breaks on control, scale, and connectivity — exactly what auditors and SOX care about."

Q: "Cash-flow hedge vs fair-value hedge?" "A cash-flow hedge protects a future forecast cash flow — the effective portion sits in OCI and recycles to P&L when the hedged item is recognised. A fair-value hedge protects the value of an existing asset/liability and both sides go through P&L. Either way I document the hedge relationship and test effectiveness under IFRS 9 / Ind AS 109."

Certification

The gold standard is the **CTP (Certified Treasury Professional)** from the AFP — the treasury equivalent of the CFA for corporate treasury, and it's named on senior treasury JDs. **ACT (Association of Corporate Treasurers)** qualifications are the UK/global route. For the tech side, Kyriba and SAP offer product certifications valued by treasury-transformation/implementation employers.

ATS keywords to add

Treasury Management System (TMS), Kyriba, SAP TRM / S/4HANA Treasury, FIS, cash positioning, liquidity management, cash pooling (physical/notional), in-house bank, payment factory (POBO/COBO), intercompany funding, FX hedging, forwards/swaps/options, natural hedge/netting, hedge accounting (IFRS 9 / Ind AS 109), cash-flow hedge, hedge effectiveness, money markets, commercial paper, repo/TREPS, MIBOR/SOFR, SWIFT, ISO 20022, MT103/MT940/pacs.008, RTGS/NEFT, settlements, confirmations, nostro/vostro reconciliation, Bank Account Management (BAM), KYC, CTP.

The Soft Skills JDs Really Test: Business Partnering, Credible Challenge, Exec Comms

The gap

Every senior finance JD lists "business partnering," "stakeholder management," "storytelling," and "commentary" — and candidates skim past them as fluff. They aren't. Above analyst level, these are the **primary screen**: two candidates have identical modelling skills, and the offer goes to the one who can influence a business head, challenge a bad number without a title, and turn a variance into a one-paragraph story an executive acts on. Your bundles teach the analysis; nobody taught you to **land** it. This chapter gives concrete frameworks — not vibes.

Why companies ask for it

> Real posting (Citi, KYC/Controls): expects officers to provide **"credible challenge"** to the business.
>
> Real posting (Dentsu, Bangalore): "Balance-sheet reconciliations & **commentary** for BS calls ... KPI dashboards ... external audit support."

Roles: FP&A business partner, financial controller, commercial finance, model-risk/2nd-line, and any GCC role that faces the client or a "BS call." "Credible challenge" is now literal regulatory language — 2nd-line functions are *required* to push back, and interviewers test whether you can.

What "proficient" looks like

You can walk into a review with a business owner who outranks you, disagree on their forecast, and leave with them agreeing — without a fight. You write a variance commentary that says **what, so-what, now-what** in three sentences, not a data dump. You can compress a 20-slide analysis into a one-page exec summary and a 4-line email. You can stand in a close/BS call and explain a movement crisply under questioning. That's the bar.

How to actually learn/do it

1. Structure every message top-down — the Pyramid Principle. Barbara Minto's rule: **answer first, then support.** Executives don't want your journey; they want the conclusion, then 3 grouped reasons, then detail on demand. Bad: "In April volumes rose, then FX moved, and after checking the ledger...". Good: "**Margin missed budget by ₹42 lakh, driven by FX (₹30L) and freight (₹12L); both reverse in Q3.**" Practice: take any analysis you've done and rewrite the opener as a single-sentence answer.

2. Frame the setup with SCQA. For any narrative or email opener: **Situation** (agreed context) → **Complication** (what changed/what's wrong) → **Question** (the implicit ask) → **Answer** (your recommendation). Example: "We budgeted 18% EBITDA *(S)*. April came in at 14% *(C)*. Why, and is it structural? *(Q)* It's a one-off FX and freight spike that reverses in Q3; no action needed beyond a hedge review *(A)*." SCQA is how you open a board narrative or a partnering conversation.

3. Apply the "so-what" test to every line. A number is not an insight. "Sales are ₹2 cr below budget" is data. "Sales are ₹2cr below budget *because two enterprise deals slipped to Q3, so full-year guidance still holds but Q2 cash is tight — recommend delaying the capex draw*" is an insight. Rule: if a sentence doesn't change what someone *does*, cut it or add the so-what.

4. Write commentary in the WWW pattern. For variance/BS commentary: **What** moved (quantified) → **Why** (the driver, not the accounting) → **What next** (action/owner/timing). One flux line: "*Accruals up ₹18L MoM — Q1 marketing invoices received late; clears in May, no P&L impact.*" That single line survives an audit and a BS call.

5. Influence without authority — business partnering. You rarely have power over the person whose number you're challenging. Levers: (a) **lead with their goal**, not finance's ("this protects your margin target"); (b) **bring the data, not the verdict** — let the number make the argument; (c) **ask, don't assert** ("help me understand the 20% uplift assumption"); (d) **give them the win** in public, the challenge in private. The mental model: you're the co-pilot who keeps the business owner off the rocks, not the auditor who says no.

6. Credible challenge — the regulated version. In 2nd-line/controls/KYC, "credible challenge" means you must formally question the 1st line and be able to evidence it. Do it with: a specific fact, a named standard or policy, and a documented outcome. "I'm challenging this customer risk rating: the screening flagged adverse media the file doesn't address; policy X requires it be dispositioned before approval; I've logged it and returned the case." That is credible (fact + standard) and it's *challenge* (you stopped the process), and it's recorded.

7. Structure an exec email / one-pager. Format: **subject line = the answer** ("Q2 forecast held at ₹18% despite April miss"); first line = ask/decision needed; then 3 bullets of why; then "detail below/attached." Under 150 words above the fold. Executives read subject + first line and decide whether to read on — earn the rest.

8. Handle the BS-review / close call. These calls interrogate balance-sheet movements. Prep: know your **top 5 movements** by value and their **one-line why**; know your **aged open items** and a resolution date for each; never say "I'll check" for a number you own — bring it. Answer in WWW, pause, and let the reviewer ask down. Composure under questioning *is* the skill being tested.

9. Executive presence. It's mostly three habits: be **concise** (say the headline, stop), be **calm under challenge** (a pushback is a question, not an attack), and **own the number** (don't hedge with "I think maybe"). Practice by summarising any analysis out loud in 30 seconds, answer-first.

Free practice: take last month's P&L or a public company's results, write the 3-sentence CFO commentary and a one-page exec summary; record yourself delivering it in 60 seconds; cut every sentence that fails the so-what test.

How it shows up in interviews

Q: "Tell me about a time you influenced a decision without authority." "The sales head wanted to book a deal in Q2 that hadn't met revenue-recognition criteria. I didn't say 'no' — I framed it around his goal, showed the Ind AS 115 criteria and what would happen if the auditor reversed it mid-year, and proposed recognising it in Q3 when it qualified cleanly. He agreed because I protected *his* credibility, not just the ledger. That's partnering: same outcome, no conflict."

Q: "Your variance report goes to the CFO — how do you structure it?" "Answer first: the one-line headline of the result versus plan. Then the two or three drivers, each quantified with a so-what — is it timing or structural, does it reverse, what's the action. Then detail as an appendix. Pyramid principle: the CFO gets the decision in ten seconds and drills only where they want."

Q: "What does 'credible challenge' mean to you?" "Questioning the first line with evidence, not opinion — a specific fact, the policy or standard it breaches, and a documented outcome. It's credible because it's grounded and it's challenge because it actually changes or stops the process, and it's on the record so the control is demonstrable."

ATS keywords to add

Business partnering, finance business partner, stakeholder management, influence without authority, credible challenge, storytelling with data, executive communication, board/CFO commentary, variance commentary, management commentary, Pyramid Principle, SCQA, executive summary / one-pager, balance-sheet review calls, close-call presentation, cross-functional collaboration, commercial finance, executive presence, data-driven decision support.

The Master Gap Checklist: Certifications & ATS Keywords to Add

This closes the guide. One place to see **every gap × who needs it × your priority**, a **certification decoder**, a **paste-ready ATS keyword bank**, and a **60-day plan** tuned to your profile: MBA-Finance + NISM + trading-desk experience + CA-Inter.

The master gap map

#	Gap (chapter)	Which roles demand it	Priority for YOU
2	**ERP at depth — SAP FICO / S4HANA, Oracle** (T-codes, tables, live posting)	Almost every R2R/P2P/O2C, FP&A, controller role (HP, Genpact, Accenture, Dentsu)	**P1 — do first**
3	**US GAAP + IFRS dual-standard** & SOX/J-SOX controls	HP, Dentsu, Luxoft, all GCC controllership	**P1**
4	**EPM/consolidation — BPC, Hyperion, Anaplan, OneStream**	Dentsu (BPC), Accenture (Hyperion/Anaplan), FP&A	**P2**
5	**Reconciliation & close tooling — Blackline**	Dentsu, most controllership	**P2**
6	**Advanced automation — Alteryx, VBA, Power Automate**	Franklin Templeton, FP&A/FA roles	**P2 — your Python helps**
7	**Regulatory reporting & Basel — AxiomSL, OneSumX, Regnology**	Luxoft, bank finance-tech	P3 (banking only)
8	**Financial-crime — KYC/AML, Actimize, ACAMS, World-Check**	Citi, Luxoft, Intel, all bank ops	**P2 — pairs with NISM**
9	**Market data terminals — Bloomberg, CapIQ, Refinitiv, FactSet**	Street Neon, Acuity, research/IB	**P1 — matches trading desk**
10	**Quant/model risk — VaR, model validation, SAS/R/MATLAB**	Acuity model risk, FRM-track	P3 (specialist)
11	**GCC operating model — R2R/P2P/O2C, WD-close, RPA, SOPs**	*Every* GCC/BPO finance role	**P1 — cheap, universal**
12	**Treasury & cash tech — TMS, FX hedging, SWIFT**	Intel, Dentsu, JPM, treasury towers	**P2 — builds on markets**
13	**Soft skills — partnering, credible challenge, exec comms**	Every role above analyst	**P1 — free, decisive**
—	**AI/GenAI literacy in finance** (agentic AI, copilots)	Genpact "AI Gigafactory", most 2026 JDs	**P1 — the 2026 differentiator**

Read the priority column as *your* sequence, given you already have markets/valuation, Python, and Excel.

Certification decoder for the gaps

Cert	Covers which gap	Cost (INR, approx)	Worth it for you?
SAP FICO (S/4HANA) certification	ERP depth (ch. 2)	₹35k–50k self-paced; more via partner	**Yes** — the single biggest keyword; even a course + sandbox counts
Blackline (free vendor cert / U)	Recon tooling (ch. 5)	Free–low	**Yes** — quick, named on JDs
Alteryx Designer Core	Automation (ch. 6)	Exam ~$0–low; free training	**Yes** — fast, resume-visible
Bloomberg Market Concepts (BMC)	Terminals (ch. 9)	~$149; free at many campuses/libraries	**Yes** — 8–10 hrs, certificate, matches trading background
ACAMS (CAMS)	Fin-crime (ch. 8)	~₹1.1–1.4 lakh	Later — gold standard AML; do after a fin-crime role bite
CTP (Certified Treasury Professional)	Treasury (ch. 12)	~₹1 lakh + AFP membership	Only if you commit to treasury
FRM (GARP)	Quant/risk (ch. 7,10)	~₹1.5–2 lakh full	Strong with your NISM/markets bent; medium-term
ESG / CFA ESG certificate	ESG reporting/BRSR	~₹60–70k	Optional edge; India BRSR is rising
CFA (you may already be eyeing)	Markets/valuation depth	High, multi-year	Long game; complements everything

Rule of thumb: **free/short certs first** (BMC, Blackline, Alteryx Core, UiPath) — they add keywords in weeks. Reserve the ₹1 lakh+ certs (ACAMS, CTP, FRM) for when a specific role stream is chosen.

The big ATS keyword bank (paste-ready, grouped)

Drop the clusters that match your target role into your resume Skills section and LinkedIn.

ERP & core systems: SAP FICO, SAP S/4HANA, SAP FI, SAP CO, Oracle Financials, Oracle Fusion, Workday Financials, T-codes (FB50, FBL3N, F-02, GR55), sub-ledger, chart of accounts.

Standards & controls: US GAAP, IFRS, Ind AS, dual-GAAP reporting, SOX, J-SOX, internal controls, Risk & Control Matrix (RCM), segregation of duties, maker-checker, external audit support.

Close & reconciliation: Record-to-Report (R2R), month-end close, working-day close (WD1–WD5), balance-sheet reconciliations, Blackline, intercompany, flux/variance commentary.

EPM / consolidation / FP&A: SAP BPC, Oracle Hyperion (HFM/Essbase), Anaplan, OneStream, consolidation, budgeting, forecasting, reforecast, driver-based planning, KPI dashboards.

Automation: Alteryx, VBA macros, Power Automate, UiPath, Automation Anywhere, Blue Prism, RPA, Power Query, workflow automation, ServiceNow.

Shared services / GCC: Global Capability Centre (GCC), shared services / GBS, P2P / Procure-to-Pay, O2C / Order-to-Cash, three-way match, cash application, DSO/DPO, SLA/KPI, SOP/DTP, transitions & migrations, knowledge transfer, hypercare, RACI.

Banking reg & risk: regulatory reporting, Basel III/IV, AxiomSL, OneSumX, Regnology, liquidity/capital reporting, VaR, model validation, model risk, SAS, R, MATLAB.

Financial crime: KYC, CDD/EDD, AML, transaction monitoring, sanctions screening, NICE Actimize, World-Check, ComplyAdvantage, customer risk rating, negative news, ACAMS/CAMS.

Market data & research: Bloomberg Terminal, Bloomberg BMC, Capital IQ, Refinitiv Eikon/Workspace, FactSet, financial databases, comps, screening.

Treasury: Treasury Management System (TMS), Kyriba, SAP TRM, FX hedging, forwards/swaps, hedge accounting (IFRS 9/Ind AS 109), cash positioning, liquidity, SWIFT, ISO 20022, settlements, CTP.

Soft / partnering: business partnering, credible challenge, stakeholder management, storytelling with data, executive communication, board/CFO commentary, Pyramid Principle, SCQA.

2026 signal: GenAI in finance, agentic AI, AI-enabled automation, finance copilots, prompt engineering for analysis.

Your 60-day "plug the top gaps" plan

Tuned to MBA-Finance + NISM + trading-desk + CA-Inter — you already own markets, Python, and Excel, so we skip those and buy the highest-leverage keywords fast.

Days 1–15 — universal, free, resume-visible. - Finish **Bloomberg BMC** (8–10 hrs) — certificate + terminal fluency that maps straight to your trading experience. *(ch. 9)* - Memorise the **GCC operating model** cold — towers, WD-close, SLAs, DTP; write one real DTP and one variance commentary in WWW format. *(ch. 11, 13)* - Draft a one-page **exec summary** of any analysis using SCQA + Pyramid; record a 60-second delivery. *(ch. 13)*

Days 16–35 — the P1 ERP + standards keyword. - Start a **SAP FICO / S/4HANA** course with a sandbox; learn 15 core T-codes and post a journal, run FBL3N, do a recon. Put "SAP FICO (in progress)" on the resume honestly. *(ch. 2)* - Do a **US GAAP vs IFRS vs Ind AS** difference sheet (revenue, leases, financial instruments) so you can speak dual-standard. *(ch. 3)* - Knock out **Alteryx Designer Core** free training + exam. *(ch. 6)*

Days 36–50 — pick ONE specialisation stream that fits you. - *If markets/research:* deepen **Capital IQ / Refinitiv**, start **FRM Part 1** reading. *(ch. 9, 10)* - *If banking ops:* do a free **AML/KYC** MOOC, learn the Actimize/World-Check workflow, plan **ACAMS**. Your NISM + trading knowledge makes fin-crime a natural bridge. *(ch. 8)* - *If corporate/GCC finance:* learn **Blackline** recon flow and **SAP BPC** consolidation basics. *(ch. 4, 5)*

Days 51–60 — package and prove. - Rebuild resume + LinkedIn from the **keyword bank** above, matched to 3 target JDs; mirror their exact phrases. - Add one **AI-in-finance** line (a real example: a UiPath bot, or a GenAI-assisted analysis) — the 2026 differentiator. *(ch. 11, intro)* - Prep the interview answers from chapters 11–13 out loud until they're automatic.

Sequence logic: free/fast keywords (BMC, GCC model, exec comms) buy interviews in two weeks; SAP + dual-GAAP is the one paid investment that unlocks the most JDs; then one specialisation makes you *the* candidate for a lane instead of a generalist. You finish 60 days with 4–5 new resume-grade keywords, one certificate in hand, one in progress, and answers rehearsed.